

HUYNH THANH NGHI

Project Leader / Bridge SE (JP ↔ VN) | Game Development · Japanese JLPT N1

Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam · (+84) 353-656-140 · huynhthanhngi0212@gmail.com

Portfolio: [nghi-huynh0212.github.io](https://github.com/nghi-huynh0212) · LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/nghi-huynh-thanh](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nghi-huynh-thanh) · itch.io: hatching-chickens.itch.io/latte-night



SUMMARY

5+ years as the bridge between Japanese headquarters, Japanese IP holders and a Vietnamese development team at a Japanese game company — translating specifications, facilitating JP–VN Q&A and managing schedules across 3 mobile titles (10M+ downloads).

- Daily work in Japanese: specs, orders and feedback translation, meeting interpretation, and negotiation with Japanese IP holders.
- Project management with Agile-style sprints for a 26-person team — e.g. 13 months of two-week releases with no missed dates.
- Requirements turned into specs, wireframes and tasks that engineers, artists and QA can build from.
- Japanese (JLPT N1, studied in Japan 2018–2020) · English (TOEIC 970) · Vietnamese (native).

EXPERIENCE

Lead Game Designer · Project Manager — enish Vietnam

08/2025 – Present

Yowamushi Pedal: Resonance Pedalism — anime-IP mobile game for the Japanese market · launched 07/2026 · 90K+ downloads in first month · 4.0+ store rating

- **Japanese stakeholders:** Main contact with the Japanese IP holder and partners, in Japanese — promotion plans, image-rights approvals and art supervision; agreed a written art review standard so approvals stopped blocking releases.
- **Project management:** Planned milestones and sprints for a 26-person team (design, engineering, art, UI, QA, sound, marketing) plus outsourced partners; ran stand-ups and retros; plans approved by the Japan office's Chief of Production.
- **Progress & reporting:** Tracked tasks, progress and issues in Redmine and Google Sheets; wrote progress reports, meeting notes and Japanese business correspondence.
- **Requirements & specs:** Analyzed benchmarks and user requests, then wrote specs, wireframes and implementation plans for engineers, artists and QA.
- **Development & QA:** Worked with engineers on game logic and master data; built AI agents for daily bug-checks (routine QA check under 10 min/day) and master-data entry.

Game Designer · Game Operator — enish Vietnam

02/2021 – 08/2025

De:Lithe Last Memories — action RPG (F2P / Web3) · 09/2022 – 08/2025 · launched 06/2024 · 800K+ downloads

- Primary JP–VN liaison across the project lifecycle — meeting interpretation and spec translation; trained new designers in both offices.
- Led the battle team; coordinated art, sound and voice orders so every stage, boss and skill shipped on schedule.

The Quintessential Quintuplets: Can't Divide the Puzzle Into Five — anime-IP puzzle game for the Japanese market · 02/2021 – 03/2022 · 9.2M downloads

- Led the 4-person Vietnam team delivering for the Japan office: an event every two weeks for 13 months with no missed release dates.
- Ran the asset order sheet between the Japanese art side and the Vietnam team; wrote official release notes in Japanese.

SKILLS

- **Bridge:** JP ↔ VN translation of specs, orders and feedback · meeting interpretation · Q&A facilitation · negotiation with Japanese clients
- **Project management:** milestone & sprint planning · stand-ups & retros · task and issue tracking · progress reporting
- **Requirements:** requirements analysis · specifications (GDD) · UI wireframes · master data
- **Tools:** Redmine · Google Sheets · Excel · Cacao · Figma · Unity · AI agents
- **Languages:** Japanese (JLPT N1, J-Test 707) · English (TOEIC 970, IELTS 7.0) · Vietnamese (native)

EDUCATION

Ho Chi Minh City University of Law — Japanese Law program

2014 – 2018

RECOGNITION

- Best Employee of the Year, enish Vietnam — three consecutive years.
- The Japan Foundation program for young Japanese researchers in Vietnam (2018); J-Debate 3rd place (2017); Nagoya University Summer Seminar (2017).

OBJECTIVE

Seeking a Project Leader / BrSE role, keeping communication between Japanese clients and Vietnamese development teams clear, accurate and on time.

PROJECT LEADER · BRIDGE SE (JP ↔ VN) · HO CHI MINH CITY

Huynh Thanh Nghi

For 5+ years I have been the bridge between Japanese headquarters, Japanese IP holders and a Vietnamese development team — translating specs, running JP–VN Q&A and keeping schedules on track. **3 titles for the Japanese market, 10M+ downloads.**

View shipped titles

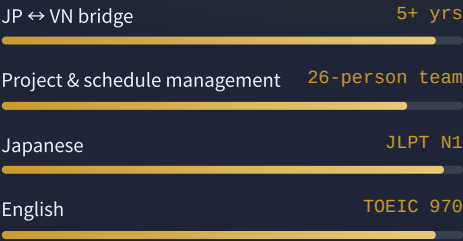
Contact

LinkedIn



PLAYER PROFILE

Class: Bridge SE / Project Leader



Shipped Titles 配信タイトル

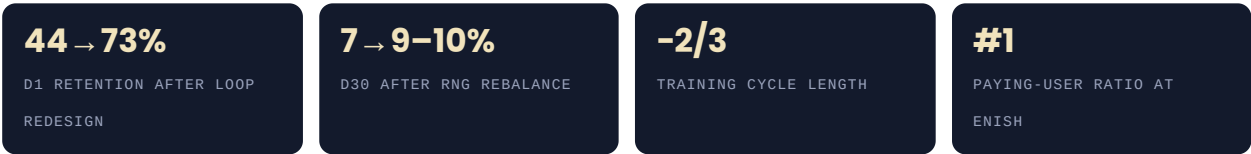
How I kept Japan and Vietnam aligned on each project, and the work that came out of it. All free-to-play mobile titles shipped at enish, mainly for the Japanese market.

LAUNCHED 07/2026 · LIVE

Yowamushi Pedal: Resonance Pedaism

弱虫ペダル レゾナンス・ペダイズム — Training sim × bicycle road racing (anime IP)

ROLE	PERIOD	DOWNLOADS	TEAM
Lead Game Designer · PM	08/2025 – present	90K+ in first month	8 designers (direct) in a 26-person team



BRIDGE & PROJECT MANAGEMENT

- **Japanese stakeholders:** main contact with the Japanese IP holder and partners — promotion plans, image-rights approvals and art supervision, all in Japanese.
- **Plan & track:** milestones and sprints for a 26-person team plus outsourced partners; stand-ups and retros; tasks and issues in Redmine and Google Sheets; plans approved by the Japan office's Chief of Production.
- **Requirements → specs:** turned benchmarks and user requests into specs, wireframes and implementation plans that engineers, artists and QA could build from.

WHAT I BUILT

- Owned the two core features — training simulation and race animation — from benchmark research and GDD to UI wireframes and shipped build.
- Level design linking trained parameters and skills to race outcomes; balanced IAP packs and gacha lineups.
- Built the milestones and the post-launch operation calendar; led the design team through launch into live ops with sprint planning, daily stand-ups and sprint retros.

PROCESS HIGHLIGHT

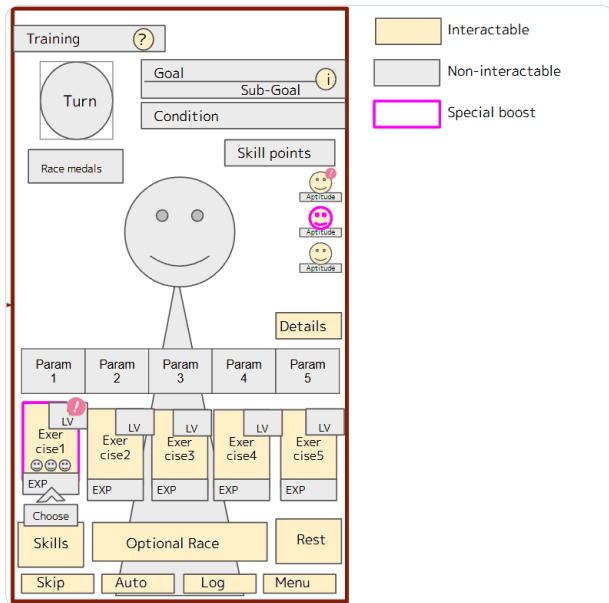
- Specced the training loop as a turn economy: five exercises feed five parameters, while goal, sub-goal and condition all compete for the same limited turns.
- Benchmarked *Uma Musume: Pretty Derby* and *Blue Lock: Project World Champion*, then decided which parameters drive stamina, speed and skill activation in a race. (Mapping under NDA.)
- Built an interaction legend into the wireframe — interactable / non-interactable / special boost — so UI, engineering and art read priority straight off the spec.
- Between test plays: cut the training cycle by two-thirds and retuned goals — players were dropping out before the payoff. Faster to the loop, not easier. **D1 retention rose from 44% to 73%.**
- After launch, D30 sat at 7% against a 10–15% target. Players weren't out of content — late-game RNG made their training and purchases feel meaningless. I rebalanced RNG to matter most in evenly matched races and fade as the power gap grows, backed by win-back campaigns. **D30 rose to 9–10%.**
- Wireframe → final: moved the race button so players stay on training until ready, and merged skill purchase into the skill-point display to cut competing controls.



Store screenshots — training loop, character development, road race

► Watch the gameplay video

WIREFRAME — SHIPPED SCREEN

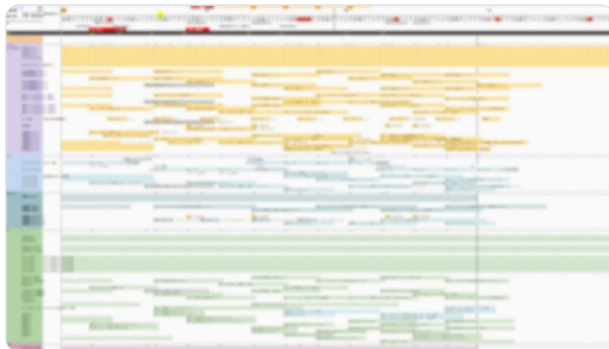


Wireframe I authored — interaction legend built into the spec



The shipped screen — same hierarchy, IP art layered on top

LIVE-OPS CALENDAR & RACE MODEL — blurred under NDA



Operation calendar I built and ran — missions, events, ranking and gacha across a quarter



Part of the race model I designed — speed, acceleration, gradient and wind corrections

RESULT

90K+ downloads in the first month, 4.0+ store rating, and the highest paying-user ratio of any title enish has shipped. D1 retention 44% → 73% after the loop redesign; D30 7% → 9–10% after the RNG rebalance. Further metrics under NDA — happy to walk through them in an interview.

09/2022 — 08/2025 · LIVE

De:Lithe Last Memories

ディライズ ラストメモリーズ — Roguelike action RPG (F2P / Web3)

ROLE	PERIOD	DOWNLOADS	SCOPE
Game Designer — Battle team lead	3 years	800K+	PvP · GvG · skills · stages

BRIDGE & PROJECT MANAGEMENT

- Primary JP–VN liaison across the whole project — meeting interpretation, spec translation and Q&A between the offices; trained new designers in both.
- Coordinated art, sound and voice orders so every stage, boss and skill shipped on schedule.

WHAT I BUILT

- Owned the competitive modes — ranked PvP and GvG — end-to-end: GDD, development, launch and post-launch tuning.
- Level design for monsters, bosses and stages; character skills from concept to numbers and balancing.
- Tuned battle feel with engineers in the in-house action-command system; directed BGM/SE/voice.
- Shipped every stage, boss and skill on schedule — placing and managing the art, sound and voice orders for each one.

PROCESS HIGHLIGHT

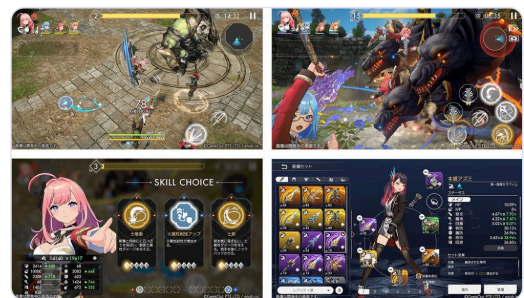
- PvP and GvG were mine from blank page to live season — running continuously since December 2024.
- Designed 60+ stages around them — 32 main-story, 12 daily, a gold-farming stage, plus the two arenas — and the monsters, bosses and skills that fill them.
- Spec'd battle feel, then tuned it with engineers until the build matched — and directed sound so a skill *reads* as powerful, not just calculates as powerful.



Boss encounter — Red Wyvern raid battle

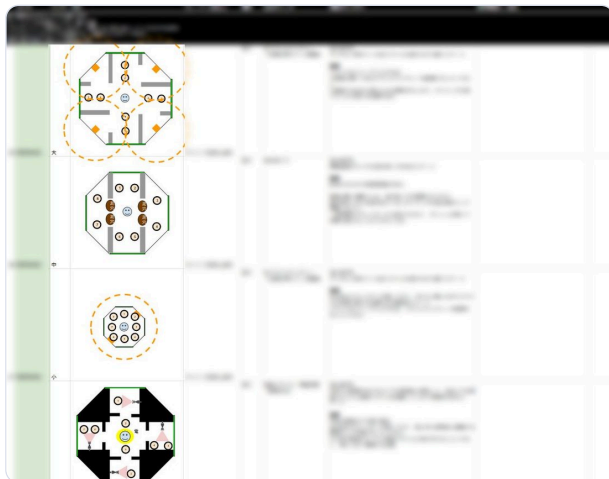


GvG objective battle — feature I owned from GDD to live

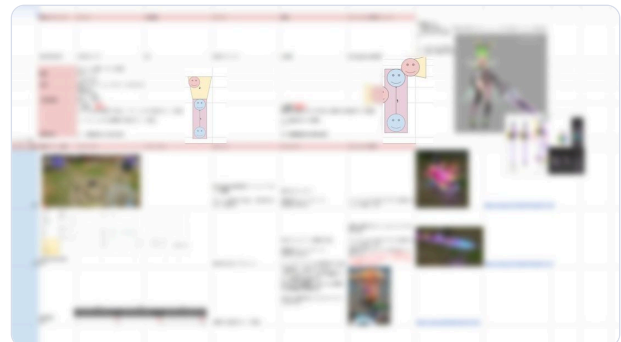


Combat, skill choice & equipment systems

DESIGN DOCUMENTS — text blurred under NDA



Stage design sheet — layout, monster placement and gimmick coverage, with the concept beside each stage



Skill sheet — attack range and motion sketched frame by frame, then spec'd for engineers and artists

RESULT

800K+ downloads since the June 2024 launch; the **PvP / GvG seasons I owned have run continuously since December 2024**. Detailed metrics under NDA — happy to walk through them in an interview.

02/2021 — 03/2022 · SERVICE ENDED

The Quintessential Quintuplets: Can't Divide the Puzzle Into Five

五等分の花嫁 五つ子ちゃんはパズルを五等分できない — Anime IP match puzzle

BRIDGE & PROJECT MANAGEMENT

- Led the 4-person Vietnam team delivering for the Japan office: an event every two weeks for 13 months, with no missed release dates.
- Ran the asset order sheet between the Japanese art side and the Vietnam team, and wrote official release notes in Japanese.

WHAT I BUILT

- Ran the live-ops pipeline — event puzzles, gacha, campaigns — leading the 4-person Vietnam team.
- Designed event puzzle levels and iterated on them with live KPI data (DAU, ARPPU).
- Shipped UI/UX improvements from reference to release; wrote official release notes in Japanese.

PROCESS HIGHLIGHT

- Held a fixed rhythm for 13 months with no missed release dates: an event every two weeks, a campaign with a new or improved feature every quarter.
- Standardised the pipeline — idea → puzzle set → master data → Japanese release note — and staggered it so two events were always in flight.
- Set difficulty from the previous event's data: clear speed, and how many players finished at all.
- The quarterly slot produced the “Cooking Raiha” idle-cooking system ([feature video](#)) — event materials got somewhere to go, so missing an event no longer meant nothing to come back for.



Event puzzle stage — level design I shipped in live ops

EVENT ASSET ORDER SHEET — text blurred under NDA

Asset ID	Asset Name	Asset Type	Asset Status	Asset Preview
1	Event Title	Event Title	Approved	
2	Event Description	Event Description	Approved	
3	Event Rules	Event Rules	Approved	
4	Event Rewards	Event Rewards	Approved	
5	Event UI	Event UI	Approved	
6	Event Assets	Event Assets	Approved	

One row per asset — brief, reference, approved final. The sheet the JP art side and the VN team worked from every two weeks

RESULT

9.2M downloads. An event every two weeks and a quarterly feature update, held for 13 months by the 4-person team I led. Detailed metrics under NDA — happy to walk through them in an interview.

Art Quality & IP 品質基準

“Doesn't look like them.” “Old-fashioned.” “Not attractive.” — vague feedback on gacha art stalls production. I wrote a review standard that turns it into criteria artists and the IP holder can check at rough stage.

- **Four gates, not a score:** identity (it's really them), character (it's like them), ownership (“I want this one”), modern appeal (holds up next to today's top gacha). A card passes only when all four do.
- **Taste made checkable:** “similar” becomes face, silhouette, expression and posture; “modern” becomes camera, light and depth against a benchmark set refreshed each quarter.
- **“Attractive” made a spec:** each art order carries one sentence defining the moment fans will want to own.
- Agreed with the IP holder over several meetings, so approvals stopped blocking releases.

アニメ IP 運営型 F2P ゲーム
ガチャキャラクターイラスト 品質定義・レビュー基準

ラフ段階で「似ている・今風・魅力的」を判定するための実務ガイド

目的
感覚的なフィードバックである「似てない」「古臭い」「魅力的じゃない」を、制作前とラフ段階で判定できる評価基準へ変換する。

1. 結論

定義
原作ファンが一目で「本人だ」と認識でき、そのキャラクターらしい新しい魅力を感じ、「この一枚を手に入りたい」と思える、現在の市場水準に達した商品ビジュアル。

品質は「本人性」「キャラクター性」「所有欲」「現代的商品性」の4軸で評価する。

軸	定義	ユーザーの反応
本人性	原作のキャラクター本人に見える	「〇〇だ」
キャラクター性	性格・関係性・世界観に合っている	「〇〇らしい」
所有欲	普段とは違う価値のある瞬間になっている	「これ欲しい」
現代的商品性	現在の高品質ガチャと並べても見劣りしない	「豪華」「新しい」

アニメ IP 運営型 F2P ゲーム・ガチャキャラクターイラスト品質定義・レビュー基準

The standard (Japanese) – definition and four evaluation axes

形状一致・演技一致＝本人性

4.「今風」の定義

「今風」は原作の絵柄を別の流行絵に変えることではない。キャラクターデザインはIPに寄せ、構図・カメラ・光・奥行き・密度などの「見せ方」を現行市場へ合わせる。

古く感じやすい状態	現代的な見せ方
正面から立っているだけ	身体の動きに明確な方向性がある
カメラが常に目線の高さ	アオリ・俯瞰・近接など意図のある画角
人物と背景が平面的	前景・人物・背景で奥行きを作る
全体が同じ密度	見せたい場所へ情報量を集中する
中央に人物を置いただけ	視線誘導が設計されている
左右対称で静的	シルエットにリズムと方向性がある
背景が単なる装飾	背景が感情や物語を補強する
汎用的なポーズ	そのキャラクター固有の瞬間を切り取る

市場ベンチマークは固定しない。直近12か月程度の高評価タイトル・同ジャンル・同ターゲットから参考画像を集め、四半期ごとに更新する。「今風」は絶対値ではなく、市場との相対評価である。

5.「魅力的」の定義

定義
「かわいい」「カッコいい」ではなく、「このキャラクターの、この瞬間を所有したい」と思えること。

ラフ制作前に、今回このキャラクターを好きな人へ何を見せるのかを一文で定義する。これを「魅力の設計文」として発注仕様へ入れる。

- 普段は強気なキャラクターが、主人公にだけ見せる一瞬の照れ。
 - 普段冷静なキャラクターが、本気の戦闘で初めて感情をむき出しにする瞬間。
 - 仲間を守るために前へ立つ、このキャラクターの最も頼もしい姿。
- 「夏なので水着」「周年なので豪華衣装」だけでは素材価値の定義として弱い。衣装や季節は題材であり、ユーザーが欲しくなる理由はキャラクターの感情・関係性・物語上の価値に置く。

アニメIP運営型IPゲーム・ガチャキャラクターイラスト品質定義・レディュー基準

Old-fashioned vs. modern presentation – taste turned into a checklist

AI Tools I Built AI活用

Agents that take the repetitive work off designers and QA.

Daily bug-check

Scans master data and code against the operation schedule every day. QA's routine check dropped to **under 10 minutes a day**.

Master-data entry

Reads level-design docs — rates, rewards, quantities — and enters the data itself. Designers only review. Doc-to-data mismatches went to **zero**.

Docs & review

Keeps every GDD and level-design doc on one format and rule set so documents never contradict each other; also reviews docs and drafts event schedules and reports.

How I Bridge Japan and Vietnamブリッジ

The habits behind five years between Japanese clients and a Vietnamese development team.

Translate intent, not just words

Specs, orders and feedback translated so the Vietnam team understands *why*, and the Japanese side gets questions answered before work starts.

Clear, timely Q&A

Questions collected, grouped and answered in one loop; meeting interpretation in both directions; decisions written down.

Schedules that hold

Milestones and sprints with stand-ups and retros; tasks and issues tracked daily; 13 months of two-week releases with no missed dates.

Specs people can build from

Requirements turned into specs and wireframes with clear priorities — the interaction legend in my wireframes lets UI, engineering and art read them at a glance.

Respect for the client's standards

Japanese business Japanese in every mail; approval rules written down with the IP holder, so reviews stop being a bottleneck.

Tools that cut risk

AI agents for daily bug-checks and master-data entry — routine QA under 10 minutes a day, zero data mismatches.

About 自己紹介

I came to games from an unusual road — a Japanese Law degree, then language school in Japan. Law taught me to read dense material closely, find the rule underneath it, and argue from evidence rather than instinct — the same muscle behind benchmark research, GDD writing, and reading KPI data before touching a number.

Every genre I've shipped in — match puzzle, action RPG, training sim — I learned from zero. Breaking an unfamiliar domain down and turning it into a spec other people can build from is what I do fastest. Japanese, Vietnamese and English are how I gather that information, not the whole of what I bring.

Five years at enish took me from operating events on a 9.2M-download puzzle game to leading the design team of a new IP title through launch. I build AI tools for my teams — a bug-check agent that cut routine QA to under 10 minutes a day, a master-data agent with zero entry mismatches — because how fast a team iterates matters as much as what it ships.

Japan is part of how I work, not just a language: I studied in Japan (2018–2020), and for five years my specs, meetings, release notes and client negotiations have been in Japanese.

Languages & Recognition

Japanese	JLPT N1 · J-Test 707
English	TOEIC 970 · IELTS 7.0
Vietnamese	Native
Best Employee of the Year, enish Vietnam	×3 consecutive
Japan Foundation young researchers program	2018

Clear communication, on schedule.

Open to Project Leader / Bridge SE roles between Japanese clients and Vietnamese teams.

huynhthanhngghi0212@gmail.com

